

SOUTH SUDAN – NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

October – November 2025 Analysis

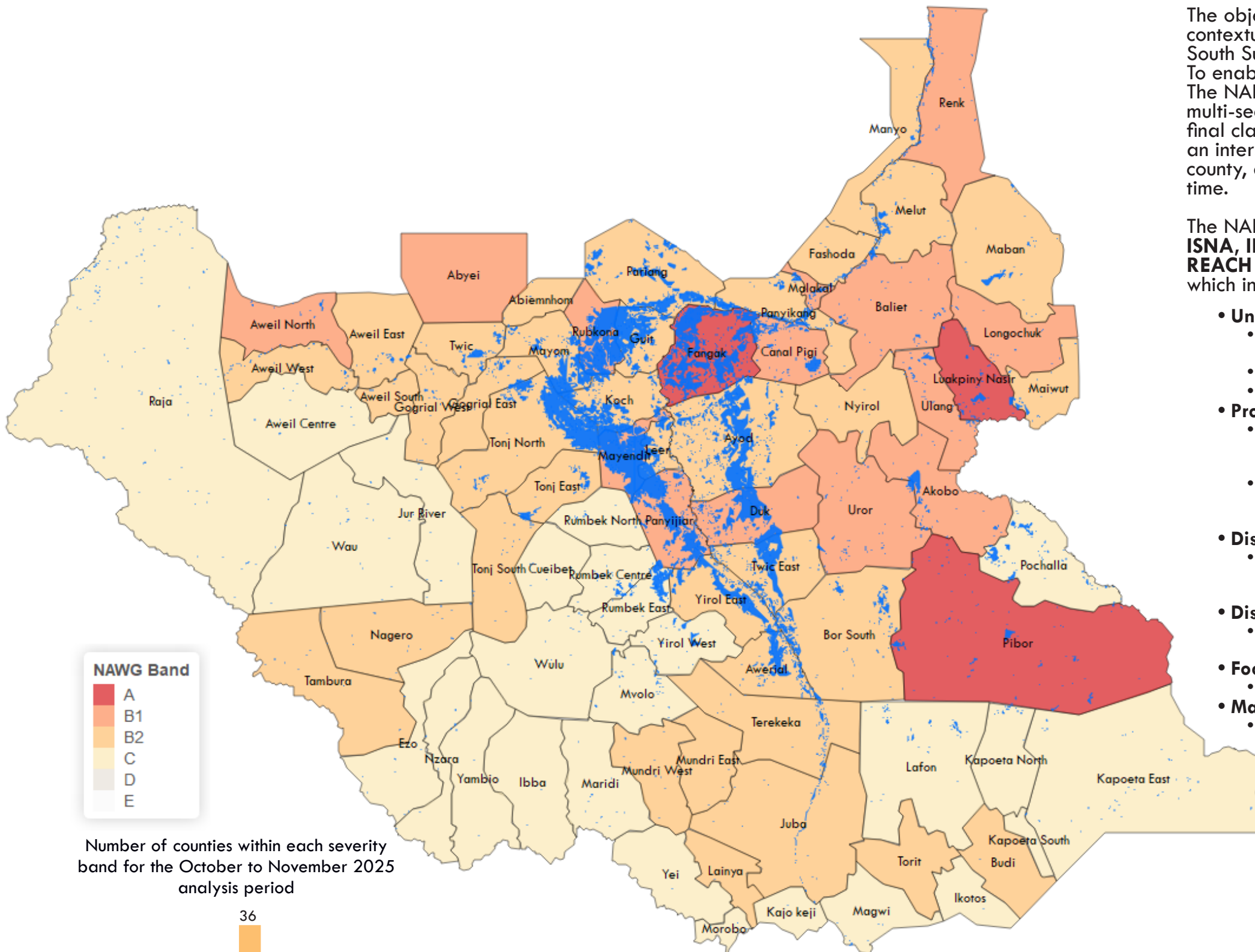
Background

The NAWG meeting was held on December 9th, 2025 to discuss the analysis of the **October to November** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of critical life-saving humanitarian needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization by the ICCG. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used as a proxy for life-threatening acute malnutrition and excess mortality risk.



Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Kumudu Sanjeewa (sanjeewa@un.org) or Mary Langan (mary.langan@impact-initiatives.org).

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The October to November NAWG analysis reveals that overall humanitarian severity remains extremely high, with all 79 counties classified between Bands A and C and none falling into the lower-severity Bands D or E. These findings also highlight a tightening cluster of high-severity counties in parts of Upper Nile, Jonglei, and Western/Central Equatoria, driven by repeated shocks, including recent conflict events and new or sustained displacement.

At the same time, the analysis underscores a set of counties requiring close monitoring due to the convergence of multiple life-threatening risks. It reveals very high levels of need in Fangak (Band A) due to massive flood-related displacement, extreme food insecurity, and limited access. Meanwhile, several Band B1 counties, such as Rubkona and Duk, are flagged due to projected extremely critical levels of acute malnutrition (IPC AMN Phase 5) between October 2025 to June 2026. Other counties, including Abyei and Renk, continue to be shaped by the spillover of the Sudan crisis and mounting pressure on already fragile WASH, shelter, and protection systems.

Counties Facing “Extreme” Humanitarian Conditions

Three counties were classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A) in this analysis period. **Fangak** and **Nasir** were automatically classified as **Band A** for having pockets of the population experiencing IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) conditions. **Pibor** was also classified as **Band A** due to the compounding impact of high protection risks, significant displacement, and severe disease burdens.

Discussion and Joint Analysis

- **Nagero:** Flagged due to reported conflict, including airstrikes and armed clashes, throughout October causing displacement within Nagero and into surrounding areas. Recent assessments by REACH and ERRM highlighted significant needs in surrounding counties. There are no reports of returns, and partner presence remains limited due to poor network and access constraints. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**
- **Tambura:** Flagged due to long-standing displacement affecting approximately 80,000 people. Displacement occurred around June, causing the population to miss the cultivation season. Food diversity is low, malnutrition levels are reportedly higher, and access is limited due to insecurity and poor road conditions. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band B2.**
- **Ezo:** Flagged due to a massive influx of over 31,000 displaced people from Tambura. Newly displaced households reportedly lack essential services, food, and access to farmland, are relying on negative

coping strategies. While needs are considerable, access is possible and some response is planned. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**

- **Wau:** Flagged due to the significant influx of IDPs, approximately 16,000 people displaced from Nagero to Bazia Payam in Wau. Assessments indicate challenging living conditions with limited food and severe WASH issues. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Mundri East:** Flagged due to conflict-driven displacement of nearly 40,000 people. Needs are high, with reports of acute food shortages and market disruptions. Families reportedly walk up to six hours to reach nutrition services, and screening is absent in most IDP sites. However, access has reportedly improved, and humanitarian response is ongoing. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**
- **Mundri West:** Flagged due to displacement of 23,000 people from Mundri East. Unlike its neighbor, reports from the field suggest Mundri West faces worse access constraints and currently has no planned humanitarian response, with markets inaccessible to IDPs due to limited purchasing power. **Elevated from Band C to Band B2, added to close monitoring.**
- **Jur River:** Flagged due to conflict events, including airstrikes and clashes in October causing internal displacement of about 5,000 people. It was noted that this was a one-off event, although anecdotal reports suggest civilians displaced toward the town center. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Torit:** Flagged due to recent violence leading to displacement of more than 3,000 individuals. Access is the primary issue, with partners unable to reach affected populations who have sought refuge in communal shelters such as schools and churches without adequate food, shelter, or protection. Humanitarian partners have activated a contingency plan for up to 20,000 IDPs. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band B2, added to close monitoring.**
- **Ibba:** Flagged due to confirmed cases of acute malnutrition and widespread hunger among over 15,000 displaced individuals. Families fled without food and lack the means to meet daily needs, relying on negative coping strategies. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Baliet:** Flagged due to projected IPC AMN Phase 5 conditions for the upcoming season and recent conflict. Concerns about accessibility along the Sobat corridor were also raised. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B2 to Band B1.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Fangak (Band A):** Continued close monitoring is required due to extreme severity (Band A), massive displacement from flooding (over 150,000 people), and extreme food insecurity. IPC analysis projects that 11,000 people will experience catastrophic food insecurity between December 2025 and July 2026.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Continued close monitoring is required due to catastrophic food insecurity pockets, limited access, and conflict. 5% of the population is projected to experience catastrophic food insecurity between December 2025 and July 2026.
- **Ulang (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to active conflict, including recent aerial bombardments targeting positions in Ying Payam, and severe food insecurity.
- **Canal/Pigi (Band B1):** Continued close monitoring due to a deteriorating situation confirmed by a recent interagency assessment, with over 25,000 people facing extreme conditions in the southern part of the county.
- **Rubkona (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to projected extremely critical malnutrition levels between October 2025 and June 2026 (IPC AMN Phase 5).
- **Duk (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to projected extremely critical malnutrition levels between October 2025 and June 2026 (IPC AMN Phase 5).
- **Abyei (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to the impact of the Sudan crisis. There is an increasingly significant military presence in Abyei, and a large and increasing number of displaced people are arriving, stretching services. The Shelter & NFI cluster is prepositioning items.
- **Renk (Band B1):** Flagged for urgent close monitoring. The situation is reportedly critical with increasing new arrivals from Sudan, some crossing through unofficial border points. A major concern is the looming water crisis in the eastern corridor, where water trucking partners have stopped operating due to funding cuts, and water reservoirs (Hafirs) are expected to dry up by December 15th, affecting over 100,000 people. The WASH cluster is mapping capacity of partners in the area and exploring solutions.
- **Longochuk (Band B1):** Close monitoring is required due to ongoing access issues and recent aerial attacks in early December, which led to the temporary suspension of some NGO activities.